

Kun Zhang

Pre-doctoral Researcher

kzhang.1@alumni.unav.es | (+34) 677 842 746 | Pamplona, Spain
kunkunz420.github.io | LinkedIn | GitHub

SUMMARY

Research interests: corporate finance, labor economics, institutional ownership, causal inference. Seeking Pre-doctoral Research Assistant positions (2026–2027), with the long-term goal of a Ph.D. in Financial Economics.

WORKING PAPER

Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility

Supervisor: Prof. José Azar (IESE & UNAV)

- Exploiting the BlackRock–BGI merger (2009) as a quasi-natural experiment, I examine how institutional common ownership shapes C-suite executive mobility.
- Using difference-in-differences and event study designs on a 27.8-million-row firm-pair panel linking 13F holdings (58.9M obs.), ExecuComp data (31,959 executive-years), and Orbis director moves (24,716 transitions), I find that common ownership increases mobility through within-network labor market channels—rejecting the shadow non-compete hypothesis.
- **Results:** Firm-level DiD: +0.073 ($p = 0.002$). Pair-level logit: $\Delta\lambda = +0.582$ ($p < 10^{-18}$). Event study: Post-2009 significant ($p < 0.001$). Robust to 17 pair-level checks, 5 placebo tests.
- **Link:** github.com/kunkunz420/common-ownership-executive-mobility

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

IESE MWOW 2026 -- Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop

Paper presented. Keynotes: Erin L. Kelly (MIT Sloan), Lauren A. Rivera (Kellogg).

May 21–22, 2026
Madrid, Spain

IESE AI Conference 2026 · Roads to Development 2026

EDUCATION

Universidad de Navarra

Master in Economics and Finance (MEF)

Sep. 2025 – Present
Pamplona, Spain

- **Relevant:** Econometrics, Mathematical Economics, Real Analysis, Statistics.

Hanyang University

Exchange, College of Economics and Finance

Sep. 2023 – Jan. 2024
Seoul, Korea

Yantai Institute of Technology

B.A. in Economics (International Economics & Trade)

Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2024
Shandong, China

EXPERIENCE

China Economic Data Analysis

Lead Developer

Oct. 2025 – Present

Shandong Dongsheng Construction

Accounting Intern

Mar. 2024 – Jun. 2024

HONORS

Outstanding Exchange Student Award (Hanyang, 2024) | Outstanding Student (Yantai, 2024) | University Python Programming Champion (Yantai, 2023)

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Technical: Python (pandas, statsmodels, NumPy), Stata, SQL, $\LaTeX$, Git, JavaScript

Languages: English (C1), Chinese (Native), Spanish (A2)